XLESS DRILL : 2016 HISTORY Social Sciences

1. With which one of the following ideas or institutions is capitalism associated?

A. Serfdom B. Equality of classes C. Controlled markets D. Making profit

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Capitalism is an economic system characterized by private ownership of the means of production and the pursuit of profit as the primary motive.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A: Serfdom is a feature of feudalism, which is the historical opposite of capitalist wage labor.

B: Capitalism creates class hierarchies based on wealth; it does not inherently promote equality of classes.

C: Capitalism relies on free-market competition rather than state-controlled markets.

2. What was the fundamental organizational change that led to the Industrial Revolution?

A. The shift from the dispersed system to factory production C. The shift from coal to water to generate power

B. The replacement of animal and human labor by machines D. The development of banks to lend money to Entrepreneurs

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The key organizational change was the shift from the domestic (putting-out) system to factory production, where workers and machinery were centralized.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: While these were significant technological or financial developments, the *organizational* change in how production was managed (the factory system) was the structural foundation.

3. Which one of the following was a consequence of the American Civil War?

A. The end of racial oppression in the USA C. The economic prosperity of the southern planter class

B. The end of the institution of slavery in the USA D. The acquisition of parts of the US by France

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The American Civil War (1861-1865) resulted in the abolition of slavery with the passage of the 13th Amendment.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A: Racial oppression continued in various forms (such as Jim Crow laws) long after the war.

C: The southern planter class was economically devastated by the war.

D: France did not acquire US territory as a result of the Civil War.

4. What was the major consequence of the Second Balkan War?

A. The deepening of hostility between Austria-Hungary and Serbia over territorial claims.

B. The forced withdrawal of Ottoman Turkey from all its European territories.

C. The emergence of conflict between emerging Balkan nationalism and the Ottoman Empire.

D. The emergence of several countries such as Greece and Macedonia as independent nations.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The Second Balkan War (1913) deepened hostility between Austria-Hungary and Serbia, as Austria-Hungary opposed Serbia's increased power and territorial gains, heightening tensions that led to WWI.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These describe outcomes of the First Balkan War or general Balkan nationalist trends, whereas the specific tension leading to WWI was the Austro-Serbian rivalry.

5. Which of the following innovations contributed to the success of European imperialism in Africa in the late 19th century?

A. The discovery of cement for building efficient roads C. The numerical superiority of white armies than Africans

B. The development of techniques for exploring minerals D. The discovery of medicinal protection against malaria

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The discovery of quinine as a prophylactic against malaria allowed Europeans to survive in tropical African interiors that were previously inaccessible to them.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: While these were helpful, none were as critical to overcoming the "white man's grave" barrier as medical protection against malaria.

6. What was the main feature of British indirect rule?

A. The exclusion of Africans from the administration of the colonies.

B. The use of extensive violence to mobilize commodities for export.

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C. The granting of Africans British citizens with their political rights.

D. The use of Africans in their administration of the colonies.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: British indirect rule used existing African traditional rulers and institutions to administer the colonies under British supervision.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These contradict the core methodology of indirect rule, which focused on co-opting local structures rather than direct exclusion or granting citizenship rights.

7. How did long distance trade facilitate interaction among Ethiopia's populations?

A. By helping introduce Orthodox to different parts of the region.

B. By giving rise to markets that served as centers of cultural interaction.

C. By spreading democratic institutions such as Gada to new areas.

D. By making use of the common media of exchange.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Long-distance trade created markets and trade routes where diverse populations met, exchanged goods, and interacted culturally.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: While these were incidental, the market centers themselves were the primary engines for cross-cultural social interaction.

8. Why did Emperor Tewodros II's modernization attempts fail?

A. He lacked the technology and resources necessary to implement the reforms.

B. He tried to simply copy western institutions rather than adapt them to local conditions.

C. He angered the European powers who could have helped him.

D. British opposed his reforms fearing he would create a strong Ethiopian state.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Tewodros II angered European powers, particularly Britain, by imprisoning missionaries and diplomats, leading to the British expedition against him.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

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A, B, D: These points are debated by historians, but the immediate cause of the failure of his reform project was the diplomatic crisis with Britain.

9. What was the consequence of the Hewett (Adwa) Treaty of 1884?

A. Return of Massawa to Ethiopia

C. Ethiopian control over Matamma

B. Ethiopian hostility with the Mahdist Sudan

D. Continuous Ethiopian war with the Egyptians

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The Hewett Treaty allowed Ethiopia to occupy Bogos, but led to Ethiopian hostility with the Mahdist Sudan over control of the region.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These were not the primary results of the treaty, which focused on the exit of Egyptian troops via Ethiopia.

10. What was the significance of the battle of Sagale of 1916 in Ethiopian politics?

A. It ended the political influence of Wallo in national politics.

B. It led to the victory of the progressive groups in court politics.

C. It marked the end of the progressive groups in court politics.

D. It marked a shift of power from Shewa to Wallo.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The battle of Sagale (1916) led to the victory of progressive groups who supported Lij Iyasu's removal and placed Empress Zewditu on the throne, with Ras Teferi (Haile Selassie) as Regent.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These mischaracterize the power shift, which reinforced the dominance of the Shewan nobility over the Wallo faction.

11. Which one of the following is correct about the importance of history?

A. It enables people to become less spiritual and more secular.

B. It helps us understand contemporary issues.

C. It encourages people to focus more on local than global issues.

D. It deepens extreme nationalism among the diverse population.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

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Explanation: History helps us understand contemporary issues by providing context and explaining how past events shape present conditions.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These are subjective or incorrect uses of history; history is meant to broaden perspectives, not shrink them or promote extremism.

12. Which of the following is correct according to the scientific theory of human evolution?

A. The earliest human species originated in Africa and spread out to other continents.

B. The major difference among the various hominid species is in terms of height and weight.

C. It is by the types of iron tools that they made that we differentiate among hominids.

D. The different hominid species in Africa descended from Lucy (Dinkinesh).

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The scientific consensus is that early hominids originated in Africa and later migrated to other continents.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These are either biologically inaccurate or oversimplifications of complex paleoanthropological classification.

13. What was the Ethiopian state that had emerged immediately before Aksum?

A. Damot B. Adulis C. Haulti D. Damat

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Damat (or Dʿmt) was a kingdom in northern Ethiopia/Eritrea that preceded and influenced the rise of Aksum.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: Adulis was a port city, not an early state; the others do not fit the chronological timeline.

14. To which language super-family do the Omotic languages belong?

A. Khoi-San

B. Niger-Congo

C. Afro-Asiatic

D. Nilo-Saharan

CORRECT ANSWER: C

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Explanation: Omotic languages belong to the Afro-Asiatic language super-family.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These are distinct linguistic super-families that do not include the Omotic group.

15. Which of the following technologies enabled ancient Egyptians to produce large surpluses and maintain an enduring state?

A. Building pyramids B. Inventing hieroglyphics C. Constructing irrigation canals D. The art of mummification

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Irrigation canals allowed ancient Egyptians to control Nile flooding and produce large agricultural surpluses.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These are cultural or religious achievements; they did not provide the food surplus needed to sustain the state.

16. Which one of the following is correct about Pre-Colonial American civilizations?

A. They all achieved high standards of urban development and high rate of city structure.

B. While the Inca built extensive roads and the Maya developed an accurate calendar.

C. The development of writing distinguished Aztec civilization from Mayan and Incan civilizations.

D. The Inca put up a stronger resistance against the Spanish because they used tools made out of silver.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The Inca are known for extensive road networks, and the Maya developed a highly accurate calendar system.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These contain historical inaccuracies or generalizations that don't reflect the distinct achievements of each individual civilization.

17. To which power did Aksum eventually lose control over the Red Sea trade?

A. Muslim Arabia B. Ottoman Turkey C. Mamluk Egypt D. Safavid Persia

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Aksum lost control of Red Sea trade to the rising power of Muslim Arabia following the expansion of Islam in the 7th century.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These powers rose to prominence much later or in different geographic regions.

18. What was the major achievement of the Muslim Arabs under the immediate successors of the Prophet Mohammed?

A. Moving the center of the empire outside of Arabia and Syria.

B. The capture of Medina and its selection as the religious center.

C. The capture of extensive territories from Persia and Byzantium.

D. The opening of trade routes connecting Arabia with India.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Under the Rashidun Caliphs, Muslim Arabs captured extensive territories from the Byzantine and Persian Empires.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These are either historically incorrect regarding the timing or secondary to the massive territorial expansion.

19. Which one of the following was a cultural feature of the Zagwe dynasty?

A. The continuation of Christianity as the official state religion.

B. The use of the Agaw language for both court and church functions.

C. The shift of the pilgrimages from the Holy Land to Lalibela.

D. The development of rules about royal succession.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The Zagwe dynasty continued Christianity as the official state religion and built famous rock-hewn churches.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: The Agaw language was not the court language (Ge'ez remained), and royal succession remained fluid.

20. Why did the medieval Ethiopian Christian kingdom rely on mobile courts?

A. The tradition of permanent capitals was not familiar before.

B. Movable capital made it possible to administer a vast empire easily.

C. Permanent capitals were easy targets for attack by subject populations.

D. The empire lacked materials to construct permanent settlements.

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CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Mobile courts allowed the king to move throughout the empire, ensuring loyalty, collecting tribute, and administering vast territories.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: The mobile system was a deliberate administrative strategy, not due to a lack of construction materials or fear of attack.

21. What was the major feature of early capitalism?

A. Greater use of money as capital rather than income.

B. The shift in motivation from making profits to humanitarianism.

C. Decline in international trade due to internal and external war.

D. Replacement of human and animal labor to machines in production.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Early capitalism saw the increasing use of money as capital (invested for profit) rather than merely as income for consumption.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These either describe later stages of capitalism (machine labor) or contradict the economic reality of the time.

22. Which of the following is correct about the expansion of the Aksumite state?

A. Its expansion was due to the desire to control trade routes.

B. It was established by immigrants from South Arabia.

C. It directly inherited the political institutions of Punt and Damat.

D. Its rulers ruled their subjects directly.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Aksum's expansion was driven by the desire to control key Red Sea trade routes for ivory, gold, and other goods.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These are either oversimplified or inaccurate descriptions of the complex Aksumite state formation.

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23. What explains the rise of the Zagwe dynasty to power?

A. Their success in effectively mobilizing the Agaw people. C. Their integration into the Aksumite economic and politics.

B. Their achievements in architectural development. D. Their success in preserving Christianity elements.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The Zagwe rose to power by effectively mobilizing the Agaw people of Lasta and defeating the weakened Aksumite rulers.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These were not the root causes of their political rise.

24. Which one of the following accounts for the downfall of the Zagwe?

A. Succession struggle B. Economic decline C. Outbreak of plague D. Religious controversy

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Religious controversy over Zagwe legitimacy (not being of Solomonic lineage) contributed to their downfall.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: While these existed, the defining historical argument for their removal was the Solomonic legitimacy crisis.

25. What idea from the Renaissance period became dominant in the Modern World?

A. The divine origin of human life C. The non-understandability of the universe

B. Reconciliability of with secular life D. Reason and the possibility of progress

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The Renaissance emphasized reason, humanism, and the possibility of human progress in science, art, and society.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These reflect the medieval worldview that the Renaissance sought to replace.

26. How Yekuno Amlak restore the so-called "Solomonic" Dynasty in 1270?

A. By referring the Zagwe as usurpers and hence eroding its acceptance.

B. By securing recognition from the Egyptian Coptic Church.

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C. By getting support from the Holy Land of Jerusalem.

D. By blocking the Zagwe from being crowned as emperors at Aksum.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Yekuno Amlak justified restoring the Solomonic dynasty by declaring the Zagwe as illegitimate usurpers who were not of Solomonic lineage.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These were tactical moves that followed his initial delegitimization of the Zagwe.

27. How did Islam spread in to central and eastern Ethiopia during the medieval period?

A. Islamic Holy war of jihads.

C. the agency of nomadic pastoralists.

B. the migration of Arab clans.

D. the activities of traders and sheikhs.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Islam spread through peaceful activities of Muslim traders and sheikhs, not primarily through conquest.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These are myths; the trade network was the primary vehicle for cultural and religious exchange.

28. What was the main factor for the expansion of the Christian kingdom in north and central Ethiopia from the 13th to the 16th centuries?

A. The wish to convert Muslim populations to Christianity

B. The desire to establish ports on the Red Sea and the Indian Ocean

C. The desire to increase revenue by controlling trade routes

D. The wish to acquire new lands for a rapidly growing population

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The Christian kingdom expanded to control profitable trade routes connecting the interior to the Red Sea coast.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These were secondary goals compared to the state-building imperative of controlling the wealth-generating trade routes.

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29. Which of the following was a consequence of the wars between the Christian State and Adal under Imam Ahmed al-Ghazi?

A. The decline of the importance of trade routes leading to Zeila.

B. The partition of the Red Sea between the Portuguese and Ottomans.

C. The end of ruling the Christian state from permanent seat in Shewa.

D. The adoption of agriculture by many pastoralists in eastern Ethiopia.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The long, destructive nature of the war devastated the infrastructure and security of the trade routes connecting the interior to the port of Zeila, leading to their prolonged commercial decline.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B: The partition of Red Sea influence was a global strategic competition, not a local consequence of this specific war.

C: The Christian state did not have a permanent seat in Shewa that "ended" due to this war; they were highly mobile.

D: This is not a historical consequence attributed to the conflict.

30. What distinguished Imam Ahmed Al-Ghazi from his predecessors?

A. His use of a cavalry rather than an infantry force in his wars.

B. His mobilization of armies from Afar and Somali in his campaigns.

C. His used the religious animosity to mobilize the Muslim population.

D. His decision to conquer the Christian kingdom rather than raid it.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: While previous Adali leaders engaged in intermittent border raiding, Imam Ahmed Al-Ghazi launched a full-scale, systematic invasion with the specific strategic goal of total conquest.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A: Both sides utilized a mix of infantry and cavalry.

B: Previous Adal leaders also drew support from the diverse groups in the region.

C: Religious rhetoric was common in previous conflicts; the scale of the objective (conquest) is what made him unique.

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31. Which one of the following explains why Italian unification became successful?

A. The adoption of a mixed strategy by the Italians that combined armed uprising and diplomatic pressure.

B. The decision of the Austrian Hapsburgs to support Italian unification.

C. The weakening of the Hapsburgs both economically and politically.

D. The mobilization of liberals, conservatives and the papal states by Piedmont-Sardinia.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Success was achieved by balancing Cavour's diplomatic maneuvers with major European powers and Garibaldi's grassroots military insurgencies.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B: Austria actively fought against Italian unification.

C: While the Hapsburgs had issues, they were still a powerful empire that had to be militarily defeated.

D: The Papal states were largely against the unification process.

32. Which one of the following was the major factor for the colonial occupation in Africa?

A. Collection of ethnographical and geographical information by missionaries and explorers.

B. Internal divisions within African societies and the factional support provided by the European.

C. Europeans military and technological superiority over the pre-colonial African states.

D. The absence of centralized state structures among many African populations at the time.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Europeans frequently exploited local rivalries, entering into treaties with one faction to defeat another, effectively using internal divisions to "divide and rule."

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: While these were facilitating factors, the political exploitation of existing divisions was the most decisive active strategy used to initiate colonial rule.

33. Who were the traders who dominated long distance trade in the Southwestern region during the 19th-century?

A. Saffare B. Jabarti C. Jallaba D. Afkala

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CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The Jallaba were specialized merchants who dominated the commerce in southwestern Ethiopia, moving goods like coffee and gold toward the north and the Sudanese border.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These groups were either active in different regions or represented different social/religious classes not identified with this specific trade role.

34. What does the Liche Treaty of 1878 tell us about Emperor Yohannes IV's style of rule?

A. He favored negotiations and power-sharing to build imperial authority.

B. He was cruel towards his rivals and sought to eliminate them for the last.

C. He lacked consistency in his approach to local rulers.

D. He was influenced by his religious thought in his administration.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Through the Liche Treaty, Yohannes IV reached a settlement with Menelik II, recognizing his title in exchange for Menelik's submission, demonstrating a pragmatic style of power-sharing rather than constant warfare.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These conflict with the evidence of his strategic, peace-seeking diplomacy during this specific period of his reign.

35. Which one of the following was a consequence of the battle of Adwa?

A. The acquisition of an outlet to the sea for Ethiopia.

B. The end of Ethiopia's encirclement by hostile powers.

C. The recognition of Ethiopia as an independent country.

D. The end of Italian colonial aspirations in the Horn of Africa.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Adwa forced European powers to officially recognize Ethiopia's sovereignty in international diplomatic circles, ending the immediate threat of colonial subjugation.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A: Ethiopia did not gain coastal access; it remained landlocked.

B: Hostile encirclement persisted for years.

D: Italy did not abandon its colonial aspirations; they returned with a vengeance decades later in 1935.

36. Which of the following was a feature of the period of the Diarchy (1923-1930) in Ethiopian politics?

A. The absence of power struggle within the ruling class.

B. Struggle for power among groups within the ruling class.

C. The introduction of major political and constitutional reforms.

D. Rapid penetration of foreign capital into the country.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: This era was defined by the deep divide between the conservative faction (loyal to Empress Zewditu) and the reformist "Young Ethiopians" (loyal to Ras Tafari/Haile Selassie).

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These do not describe the fundamental, destabilizing political rivalry that defined the period.

37. Why did the Shewan nobility remove Lij Iyasu from power in 1919?

A. They disliked his attempt to undermine Shewan dominance.

B. She favored the Germans over the British and France diplomatic shift.

C. She began to reverse the modernization steps of Emperor Menelik.

D. She demonstrated lack of judgement in making decisions.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Lij Iyasu's policy of shifting power centers away from the Shewan nobility to the people of the periphery threatened the established political order in the center.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These were pretexts or side-issues; the threat to the political power of the Shewan establishment was the root cause.

38. Which one of the following initiatives of Lij Iyasu can be said to have improved the condition of the Ethiopian peasantry?

A. The establishment of a modern police force called Terembulle as the first municipal force.

B. The requirement that all businesses should be audited periodically.

C. The appointment of local administrators on the basis of merit.

D. The decision that the payment of tithe (asrat) should be on the basis of actual produce.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Basing taxation on actual harvest rather than a fixed arbitrary amount provided a critical safeguard for farmers during bad agricultural years.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These were administrative or municipal changes that did not directly alleviate the tax burden on the peasantry.

39. In what way did the Constitution of 1931 contribute to the consolidation of Haile Selassie I's autocratic power?

A. It gave the emperor the right to pardon crimes against the state.

B. It created a parliament that would debate and approve legislation.

C. It reduced the power of nobilities not to challenge his power.

D. It enhanced the image of the emperor as a progressive leader.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: By codifying the Emperor's position as absolute and centralizing administration, it formally marginalized the regional nobility, preventing them from challenging him as they had in the past.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: While these were parts of the constitution, the reduction of noble power was the essential step for his autocracy.

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40. Which one of the following African resistance movements was related to colonial Cotton plantation?

A. The Ndebele resistance in Zimbabwe C. The resistance of the Ashanti kingdom

B. The Maji Maji rebellion in Tanganyika D. The resistance of the Mandinka Empire

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The Maji Maji rebellion was specifically triggered by the forced labor and harsh conditions imposed on the local population to cultivate cotton for German colonial markets.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These resistances were driven by different colonial triggers (land encroachment, sovereignty, etc.), not cotton specifically.

41. Why did Bismarck organize the alliance system?

A. To solve European colonial rivalry in Africa peacefully. C. To support the Ottoman Empire against Russian expansion.

B. To weaken British dominance in European politics. D. To secure protection for Germany against French hostility.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Bismarck's "nightmare of coalitions" meant he feared France would team up with other powers to attack Germany; the alliance system was designed to keep France diplomatically isolated.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These were not the primary strategic motives for Bismarck's European alliance architecture.

42. Which of the following was a consequence of the 1917 Revolution in Russia?

A. The restoration of Russian control over neighboring states such as Ukraine and Poland.

B. Implementation of the Communism as an official ideology in Russia and influenced other world.

C. The withdrawal of Russia from international politics until the beginning of WWII.

D. The shift of Russian modernization efforts from the cities to the countryside.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The revolution resulted in the creation of the USSR and the export of Marxist-Leninist ideology, which fundamentally changed 20th-century geopolitical history.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These describe outcomes that are either historically inaccurate or fail to capture the defining global impact of the revolution.

43. What was the immediate cause of the Second World War?

A. The publication of the Axis powers' secret plan to partition the globe.

B. The withdrawal of Germany's pledge to guarantee the sovereignty of Czechoslovakia.

C. British decision to occupy the port of Danzig as a pre-emptive action against German invasion.

D. Germany's invasion of Poland threatened both Britain and France.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Hitler's invasion of Poland crossed the "red line" for Britain and France, who had guaranteed Polish independence.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These do not represent the direct diplomatic trigger for the outbreak of war in September 1939.

44. Which organ of the UN was responsible for facilitating the independence of former mandated territories?

A. The Security Council

B. The Trusteeship Council

C. The International Court of Justice

D. The UN Secretariat

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The Trusteeship Council was explicitly created to transition former colonies (Trust Territories) toward self-governance and independence.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These bodies deal with security, legal disputes, and administrative support, not the transition of mandates.

45. Which of the following was a consequence of the Marshall Plan?

A. The containment of Communism from spreading to Asia and Africa.

B. The division of Germany between the Capitalist West and Communist East.

C. The extension of American political influence to Latin American countries.

D. The economic recovery of Western European countries after WWII.

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CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The Marshall Plan injected billions of dollars into Western Europe, preventing economic collapse and helping rebuild industrial centers, which stabilized the region.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: While it helped contain communism in Europe, the primary direct consequence was Western European economic recovery.

46. What was the cause of the Cold War?

A. Conflict between the supporters of free market & planned economic systems.

B. Desire of the super powers to extend their political and strategic influence across the globe.

C. Difference between the two superpowers on how to partition Africa and Asia.

D. Rivalry between the super powers to send the first mission to outer space.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The Cold War was a systemic global struggle for hegemony between the US and the USSR, as both sought to install their respective political/military influence worldwide.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These were symptoms and areas of competition, but the desire for global strategic influence was the fundamental root of the rivalry.

47. Which of the following countries did NOT belong to the Warsaw Pact?

A. Romania B. The Soviet Union C. West Germany D. Hungary

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: West Germany was a foundational member of NATO and a staunch US ally, not part of the Eastern Bloc.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These were active members of the Warsaw Pact defense alliance.

48. What was the Vietnamese city that was renamed as Ho Chi Minh City following Communist victory over the US?

A. Saigon B. Peking C. Dien Bien Phu D. Hanoi

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CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Upon the unification of North and South Vietnam in 1975, the city of Saigon (capital of the former South) was renamed to honor the revolutionary leader Ho Chi Minh.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These are incorrect city names for the capital of the South Vietnamese state.

49. Which of the following was a factor for the collapse of Communism in the late 1980s?

A. The rise of anti-communist movements in the Eastern Europe

B. Political and economic reforms initiated by Gorbachev

C. Rivalry between the Soviet and Chinese forms of communism

D. Loss of popular support for the ideology at the global level

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Gorbachev's glasnost (openness) and perestroika (restructuring) allowed suppressed political movements to rise, ultimately leading to the rapid disintegration of the Soviet bloc.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These were secondary factors that were accelerated by Gorbachev's reform policies.

50. Why did the Imperial government fail to carry out a land reform program in the late 1960s and early 1970s?

A. It lacked the technical and financial resources for its realization.

B. It feared that there would be opposition from the peasantry.

C. It was preoccupied with peasant rebellions in Gojjam and Bale.

D. It feared that there would be strong opposition from the big land owners.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The imperial throne relied on the support of the regional nobility and the Church, who were the biggest landowners; a meaningful reform would have meant destroying the throne's own political power base.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: While technical issues existed, the political fear of losing the landed elite's support was the primary reason the regime paralyzed itself.

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51. To which of the following is the concept of objectivity related when applied to the study of history?

A. Interpret events based on one's subjective experience.

C. Avoid subjectivity on the part of the historian.

B. Explain change in a clear and logical manner.

D. Identify original sources by the historian

.CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Historical objectivity is the professional ideal of setting aside one's own values and prejudices to interpret historical evidence as truthfully and neutrally as possible.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These describe parts of the process of history, but not the specific definition of "objectivity."

52. What is the significance of periodization in historical studies?

A. Trace continuities and change through time.

B. Make the work of history to screen usable sources.

C. Distinguish professional history from popular history.

D. Sort out factual details from factious narratives.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Periodization (e.g., "Middle Ages," "Renaissance") helps historians identify patterns, turning points, and shifts in human society over long stretches of time.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These are not the functions of periodization; they are other aspects of historiographical practice.

53. With which of the following homo species are Achulean tools associated?

A. Homo africanus B. Homo habilis C. Homo erectus D. Homo sapiens

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The Acheulean tool industry, characterized by distinctive "hand axes," is the classic technological trademark of Homo erectus.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: While these species used tools, the Acheulean industry specifically defines the Homo erectus era.

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54. Which of the following is a characteristic of the Upper Paleolithic?

A. Composite tools made out of stone and Bone

B. Lack of change in tool making techniques in Africa

C. Tools made out of metals like copper and bronze

D. Highly selective breeding of livestock

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: This era saw a revolution in technology where humans began hafting stone microliths onto bone or wood handles (composite tools), greatly increasing hunting efficiency.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C, D: These either misidentify the technological capabilities or the era entirely.

55. Which one of the following explanation is NOT correct according to the theories of emergence of early states?

A. Those who control trade routes become rulers.

B. Successful military leaders become kings.

C. Priests established political control in the name of gods.

D. People who organize religious pilgrimages become leaders.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: While religion is a factor, "organizing pilgrimages" is not a widely accepted primary mechanism for the formation of early centralized states in historical theory.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These are the three pillars of standard political science theories regarding the rise of early archaic states (Trade, Force, and Religion).

56. Which one of the following was a major achievement of the Indus Valley civilization?

A. The development of a writing system

B. The construction of refined Buddhist temples

C. The development of urban planning techniques

D. The writing of a complex legal code

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The Indus Valley cities (like Mohenjo-Daro) are world-famous for their grid-patterned streets, indoor plumbing, and standardized drainage, which were far ahead of their time.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, D: These are achievements either attributed to other civilizations or not characteristic of the Indus sites discovered thus far.

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57. What was the major contribution of Greek civilization to the Western world?

A. Ideas about direct participatory democracy

B. Rejection of slavery as an institution

C. Techniques of building roads that last long

D. The use of the wheeled transport

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The Athenian system of allowing citizens to directly vote on legislation remains the historical archetype for Western democratic theory.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B: The Greeks heavily relied on slavery.

C, D: These were technologies used by many ancient cultures, not a unique Greek "contribution" to the West.

58. What was a common achievement of the civilizations of Egypt and Mesopotamia?

A. The invention of techniques for preserving the bodies of the dead.

B. The development of a writing system for administrative purposes.

C. The construction of elaborate religious buildings using clay bricks.

D. The invention of techniques for purifying copper and iron.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Both civilizations evolved writing (hieroglyphics and cuneiform) specifically to manage their respective grain-taxing and bureaucratic systems.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, C, D: These are either specific to one culture or were not the "common" administrative milestone they both reached.

59. Which of the following characterizes feudal society in Medieval Europe?

A. The revival of patronage for Arts and Architectures

B. The establishment of centralized empires

C. The existence of large and flourishing trade centers

D. The decentralization of state power

CORRECT ANSWER: D

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Explanation: Feudalism was the opposite of a centralized empire; it was a structure where kings lost their power to local lords (dukes/counts) who held military and judicial power over their local manors.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A, B, C: These are characteristics of different eras, such as the Renaissance or late Middle Ages.

60. Which of the following is correct about Byzantine emperors?

A. They were both religious and political leaders.

B. Their power was checked by the Orthodox Church.

C. They exercised absolute power over their subjects.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The concept of "Caesaropapism" meant that the Emperor was not only the head of the state but also the supreme authority in the Eastern Orthodox Church.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

B, C: While they were powerful, the church and state were inextricably linked, meaning the church supported, rather than "checked," the Emperor.

61. Why did the 1960 attempted coup against Emperor Haile Selassie fail?

A. There was disagreement between the coup leaders on what to do with Haile Selassie's officials.

B. The coup leaders failed to secure support from the army and the air force.

C. The coup leaders failed to secure control of the radio station and the imperial palace.

D. The coup leaders did not set up a government immediately after capturing power.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The coup plotters, led by the Neway brothers, failed to capture key communication infrastructure like the radio station and the palace early on, which allowed loyalist forces to broadcast the Emperor's return and rally the military against the rebels.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

A: Disagreement existed, but it was not the tactical reason for the failure of the coup itself.

B: The coup leaders attempted to secure this support, but the failure to control communication meant they could not convince the broader military of their success.

D: Setting up a government was part of their plan; the failure was strictly military/tactical in securing the capital.

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62. Which of the following initiatives of the Derg had a major socio-economic consequence for the peasantry?

A. The Land Reform B. The Literacy Campaign C. The nationalization of industries D. The confiscation of extra houses

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The 1975 Land Reform Proclamation abolished private land ownership, redistributed land to the tillers, and dismantled the feudal *gult* system, fundamentally altering the social structure of rural Ethiopia.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **B, C, D:** While these were major Derg policies, they primarily affected urban populations, workers, and industries rather than the agrarian-based peasantry.

63. What was the major factor for the outbreak of the Ethio-Somalia War of 1977/78?

A. Difference over interpreting the teachings of Marxism-Leninism.

B. Rivalry between the two countries over the issue of Djibouti.

C. Republic of Somalia claimed the Somali-inhabited territories of eastern Ethiopia.

D. Personal animosity between Colonel Mengistu and General Siad Barre.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The war was driven by the "Greater Somalia" irredentist ideology, where Siad Barre sought to forcibly annex the Ogaden region of Ethiopia, which was inhabited by ethnic Somalis.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A:** Both were ostensibly socialist states at the start; Marxism was not the cause of the war.
- **B, D:** These were secondary factors or context, but not the primary cause of the invasion of the Ogaden.

64. How did France punish Guinea for voting against continued political association with the former colonial master?

A. Sponsoring a coup against Sekou Toure C. Establishing a rival government in France

B. Denying any form assistance to the country D. Expelling Guinea from the French Union

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: In 1958, when Guinea voted "No" to the French Community, France reacted by immediately withdrawing all administrative staff, destroying infrastructure, and cutting off all financial and technical aid.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A:** France did not sponsor a coup at that exact moment.
- **C, D:** These were not the methods used to economically isolate and punish the country.

65. Which of the following shows the continued influence of western countries over the economies of African countries after independence?

A. The export of primary and industrial products to western countries.

B. The dependence on infrastructure built by the west.

C. The dependence on western models of education.

D. The dependence of African countries on western loans.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Post-independence, many African nations struggled with high external debt, which led to reliance on Western loans and the imposition of structural adjustment policies (SAPs) by Western-controlled institutions.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** These are aspects of colonial legacy, but the direct *economic control* mechanism remains the debt-loan cycle.

66. What was the characteristics of coups in African politics after independence?

A. Although coups were instrumental in removing authoritarian leaders, the regimes that replaced them brought very little change.

B. Although coups were carried out by the military, the latter proved a revolutionary force of change in many African countries.

C. Unlike coups carried out in former French colonies, coups in former British colonies succeeded in bringing change.

D. Coups carried out by junior officers were successful in bringing change than coups led by generals.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Historically, most military coups in Africa acted as "palace coups" that replaced one military or authoritarian leader with another, often maintaining the same underlying power structures without real structural reform.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **B, C, D:** These are not supported by the general trend of post-independence African political instability, where military rule rarely led to democratic or structural shifts.

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67. What was the major political agenda of the Transitional Period (1991-1994) in Ethiopia?

A. Finding a new foreign partner to help with economic and social recovery.

B. Re-establishing an Ethiopian army on the basis of ethnic and regional representation.

C. Transforming the country from a centralized command economy to one based on market liberalism.

D. Developing a constitution that would guarantee both the democratic rights of individuals and groups.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The Transitional Government's primary mandate was to draft a new constitution (adopted in 1994) that restructured Ethiopia as a federal state based on ethnic-regional lines and individual/group rights.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** While economic recovery and military changes occurred, they were components of the broader agenda to reorganize the state through the new constitutional framework.

68. In which of the following countries did Ethiopia take part in a UN led Peacekeeping mission?

A. Zimbabwe B. Sierra Leone C. Liberia D. Chad

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Ethiopia has been one of the largest contributors to the United Nations Mission in Liberia (UNMIL) and other regional stabilization missions.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** While Ethiopia has been involved in many missions, Liberia (UNMIL) is the specific mission most commonly associated with its peacekeeping history in this context.

69. Which of the following features of indigenous knowledge has the potential to contribute to overall development of a society?

A. Its sense of superiority C. Its disregard for morality

B. Its unchanging nature D. Its holistic nature

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Indigenous knowledge is "holistic" because it integrates social customs, environmental management, and traditional economics into a unified system that is highly adapted to local conditions.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** These negative characteristics are not features of indigenous knowledge and would not contribute to societal development.

70. Which one of the following is NOT an example of cultural heritage?

A. The Palace of Abba Jifar

B. Halala Kella of Dawro

C. The Semen National Park

D. The Al Najashi Mosque

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Cultural heritage refers to human-made structures or traditions; Semen National Park is categorized as *natural heritage* due to its unique ecosystem and biodiversity.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These are all human-built historical sites or religious structures, making them cultural heritage.

71. Why did the Schlieffen plan fail in the WW1?

A. Germany did not receive support from Turkey on time.

B. Russia mobilized quickly and attacked Germany.

C. The US refused to send the arms Germany had paid for.

D. Germany did not have air superiority on the western front.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The plan assumed Russia would take weeks to mobilize. However, Russia mobilized much faster than anticipated, forcing Germany to divide its forces on two fronts early in the war.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These were not the tactical or strategic reasons for the failure of the Schlieffen Plan.

72. What was the difference between the self-help associations and the political parties that emerged in Africa in the inter-war period?

A. The former supported colonial rule while the latter demanded independence.

B. The former were led by the educated elite while the latter were led by traditional leaders.

C. The former were primarily concerned with economic issues while the latter focused on broader political matters.

D. The former called for gradual transfer of power to Africans while the latter demanded speedy transfer.

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CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Self-help organizations were focused on social welfare, mutual aid, and community economic needs, whereas political parties were structured to challenge colonial governance and demand rights.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These descriptions inaccurately characterize the typical goals or leadership structures of these movements.

73. Following the Wal-Wal incident of 1934, what action taken by Italy caused the outbreak of war between Ethiopia and Italy?

A. Submission of unacceptable demands to the Ethiopian government.

B. Decision to take the conflict to the League of Nations.

C. Deployment of army between Italo-Somaliland and Ethiopia.

D. Attempt to incite local populations in the border areas to rebel.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Italy used the clash at Wal-Wal to issue a series of impossible ultimatums and demands, which was a clear diplomatic pretext for their invasion.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **B, C, D:** These were either not the specific causes or not the *primary* trigger for the war outbreak in 1935.

74. Why did the US declare war on Japan in the Second World War?

A. The US disliked the prospect of a modernizing and rising Japan.

B. Japan attacked US bases on the Pacific at Pearl Harbour.

C. Japan criticized US support for the Allies power in the Pacific.

D. The US wanted to take over Japan's colonies in the Far East.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The surprise attack on Pearl Harbor on December 7, 1941, was the direct catalyst that forced the United States to join the war.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These were geopolitical tensions, but none were the *immediate* cause of the declaration of war.

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75. What is the connection between the Atlantic Charter and the future UN?

A. The establishment of an international organization to ensure world peace.

B. The various bodies of the future United Nations to be functionary.

C. A detailed description of how the United Nations would be run.

D. The UN would be a failure if the Security Council was dominated by the Big Five.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The 1941 Atlantic Charter, signed by Churchill and Roosevelt, included the promise to establish a permanent international system for world peace, which eventually became the United Nations.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **B, C, D:** These were not the purposes of the Charter, which was a broad statement of principles, not a bureaucratic rulebook.

76. What was the cause of the First Arab-Israeli War of 1948/1949?

A. British decision to take the issue of Palestine to the UN.

B. The Arab States' refusal to accept the partition of Palestine.

C. US decision to recognize the establishment of the state of Israel.

D. The Israeli occupation of Jerusalem and the West Bank.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Arab nations rejected the UN's plan to partition Palestine into separate Arab and Jewish states, leading them to declare war immediately following Israel's 1948 declaration of independence.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These were contributing factors or later consequences, but the rejection of partition was the immediate *casus belli*.

77. Which of the following was common to national liberation movements in Kenya and Algeria?

A. Strong influence of communist ideology

B. Strong support from Socialist Tanzania

C. Resort to armed struggle as a strategy

D. Internal power struggle among the leaders

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Both the Mau Mau uprising in Kenya and the FLN revolution in Algeria relied on protracted armed guerrilla warfare as the primary method to combat colonial rule.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** While these might have existed in some form, "armed struggle" is the shared, definitive historical feature.

78. Which one of the following African nationalist leaders took part in the 1945 Pan-African Congress that took place at Manchester?

A. Edward Blyden B. Julius Nyrere C. Gamal Abdel Nasser D. Kwame Nkrumah

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Kwame Nkrumah, along with W.E.B. Du Bois, was one of the primary organizers of the Fifth Pan-African Congress in Manchester, which is considered the turning point for African anti-colonial nationalism.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** These leaders were either from a different generation or not present at this specific event.

79. Which one of the following developments characterizes the post-liberation period in Ethiopia?

A. Frequent coup attempts C. Consolidation of autocracy

B. Suppression of landlordism D. The expansion of education

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: After 1941, the Haile Selassie regime focused on modernizing the state apparatus, and the expansion of modern education (including the creation of university systems) was a major state-led initiative.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** While consolidation of power happened, the expansion of education is the most distinct social developmental change of that specific era.

80. Why did the Ethio-Eritrean federation fail?

A. The arrangement was subverted by the Italians.

B. Both unionists and separatists were dissatisfied with it.

C. The UN did not provide the support that was promised to Ethiopia.

D. The federal representative in Asmara was corrupt and ineffective.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The federation created a fragile middle ground; unionists in Eritrea wanted full integration with Ethiopia, while separatists wanted total independence, leaving neither side happy with the compromise.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These were external or bureaucratic complaints, but the internal political dissatisfaction of the Eritrean groups was the cause of the failure.

81. Which of the following Oromo group settled in the south western part of the Ethiopian region?

A. Mecha B. Borana C . Gujji D. Ittu

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The Borana Oromo are traditionally associated with the southern and southwestern migrations and the historical origins of the Gadaa system.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These other groups are associated with different regions, such as the central highlands or eastern Ethiopia.

82. Why did Emperor Susenyos accept Catholicism?

A. He believed that the Catholic doctrine was superior to the teachings of the Orthodox Church.

B. He wanted Portuguese military help in securing an outlet through the Red sea.

C. He wanted to become rich and powerful by taking over the lands of the Orthodox Church.

D. He hoped to get military support from the Catholic countries against his rivals.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: Susenyos was a pragmatic ruler facing constant internal rebellions; he believed that aligning with the Catholic world would bring essential Portuguese military technology and troops to crush his internal opponents.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** These were not the strategic motivations behind his controversial religious conversion.

83. With which of the following was the Zemene Mesafint associated?

A. Revival of commerce and crafts C. Doctrinal controversies in the Church

B. Consolidation of monarchical power D. Improvement of peasant conditions

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CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The Era of the Princes (Zemene Mesafint) saw intense theological debates in the Church, specifically the controversies regarding the nature of Christ (*Qibat* vs. *Sost Lidet*), which mirrored the regional political divisions.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These were not characteristic of this era; in fact, the era was defined by decentralized power and socio-economic decline.

84. What was the consequence of the Tokugawa Shogunate's seclusion policy for Japan?

A. It ended Japanese voyages of discovery in Asia and hence its economic benefits.

B. It prevented Japan from importing firearms and hence the capacity of the state to consolidate power.

C. It weakened Christianity in Japan by limiting regular contacts between the Japanese and foreigners.

D. It limited the development of Japanese international trade and hence retarded its capitalistic development.

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: By isolating Japan, the Shogunate cut off the potential for global trade and the growth of the merchant class, significantly slowing the development of indigenous capitalism until the Meiji Restoration.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** These are side effects, but the economic retardation of capitalism is the major consequence cited by historians.

85. What was the statement by John Locke that justified rebellion?

A. That a government cannot ask its people for additional taxes without approval by parliament.

B. That a government which cannot protect the natural rights of its people is not a government.

C. That in order to govern, a government is dependent on its ability to offer physical security.

D. That the legitimacy of a government is dependent on its ability to offer physical security.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Locke’s theory of the "Social Contract" argues that the only reason to have a government is to protect natural rights (life, liberty, property); if the government fails, the people have a moral duty to dissolve it.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These are incorrect interpretations of Locke's specific theory of *natural rights* and the *right to revolution*.

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86. What explains the involvement of large numbers of ordinary people in the French revolution between 1788 and early 1789?

A. The introduction of revolutionary ideas from the Americas

B. The collapse of the state's security system

C. The defeat of France in the Seven years' War

D. The food crisis

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The "Great Fear" and the riots in Paris were driven primarily by a desperate food shortage, where rising bread prices left the poor unable to eat.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** These were the intellectual or political precursors, but the *immediate involvement* of the masses was fueled by hunger.

87. Which one of the following was a consequence of the Industrial Revolution?

A. The decline of the urban population

B. The spread of the factory system

C. The improvement of the life of workers

D. The abolition of manual labor in manufacturing

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The revolution replaced home-based craft production with large-scale factories, which became the standard organizational unit of the modern economy.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These are either false or ignore the massive social degradation (child labor, overcrowding) that occurred before any improvement.

88. How did the Congress of Vienna of 1815 seek to establish peace across Europe?

A. By establishing a balance of power among the European powers.

B. By weakening the economic and military capabilities of France.

C. By recognizing the democratic and nationalistic aspirations of European populations.

D. By agreeing to support the reforms of liberalizing European governments.

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: The diplomats at Vienna aimed to create a stable "concert" where no single nation (like France again) could dominate the continent, ensuring long-term stability.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **B, C, D:** These were not the primary strategic mechanisms of the Congress, which sought to *repress* liberalism rather than support it.

89. Which one of the following group was able to establish their own dynasty in Egypt?

A. Funj B. Almohads C. Abdallabi D. Mamluks

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The Mamluks, originally a military caste of slave-soldiers, rose up and took control of Egypt from the Ayyubid dynasty in 1250.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** These groups were active in the Maghreb or Sudan, not Egypt.

90. Which one of the following was a consequence of the Trans-Atlantic Slave Trade?

A. The overthrow of oppressive regimes by force of arms.

B. Greater availability of land and hence expansion of the economy.

C. The weakening of indigenous crafts and technology due to import of European goods.

D. The rapid increase of population due to introduction of new food crops and medical technologies.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The influx of cheap European manufactured goods, coupled with the drain of the most productive population (the young), effectively gutted indigenous industries like weaving and iron-working.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These are incorrect or paradoxical in the face of the massive human drain caused by the trade.

91. Which of the following Ethiopian states had emerged first?

A. Gojjam B. Damot C. Enareya D. Wolayta

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Damot is historically cited as one of the oldest centralized states in the region, pre-dating the consolidation of the smaller states listed.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These states emerged later as regional powers during the subsequent medieval political reorganization.

92. Which one of the following was an outcome of the formation of the Ottoman Empire?

A. The weakening of the Persian Empire

B. The spread of pastoral nomadism across Asia

C. The decline of trade between Europe and Asia

D. The expansion of Islam in the Balkan Peninsula

CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: As the Ottomans conquered the Balkans, their administrative and religious influence spread, leading to a significant Muslim presence in places like Bosnia, Albania, and Kosovo.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** While trade was disrupted, the *spread of Islam* is the major cultural and demographic outcome of their imperial expansion.

93. Which one of the following was a key feature of early capitalism in Europe?

A. The relocation of manufacturing from the cities to the countryside.

B. Massive investment in the construction of railways and roads.

C. The development of a banking system that facilitated long distance trade.

D. The decline of the power of the bourgeoisie in local and international trade.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The invention of modern banking (credit, bills of exchange) was essential to early capitalism because it allowed merchants to conduct high-value long-distance trade without physical bullion.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These describe shifts that happened either *before* or *during* the later Industrial Revolution, not the early "merchant" phase of capitalism.

94. What was the motive behind the involvement of the Portuguese and Ottomans in the Ethiopian region in the 16th-century?

A. Establishing control over the source of the Abbay

B. Spreading their respective religions in the region

C. Finding markets for their manufactured goods

D. Extending their economic and political influence in the region

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CORRECT ANSWER: D

Explanation: The Horn of Africa was a vital choke point for the global Red Sea and Indian Ocean trade. Both empires sought to influence the Christian and Muslim states to secure their own strategic maritime and economic interests.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, C:** While religion was used as a justification, the primary motive for global empires was economic/political regional influence.

95. Which one of the following region was believed to have been an area of Oromo settlement prior to their 16th-century movement?

A. The Ethio-Sudan borderlands C. The area between the upper Ganale and Juba

B. The upper course of the Awash River D. The area adjoining upper Ganale

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: Anthropological and historical evidence points to the region between the upper Ganale and Juba rivers as the core cradle of Oromo culture and the Gadaa system.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These were regions the Oromo migrated *into* during their later expansions.

96. Which of the following 19th-century Ethiopian societies shared a similar system of political organization?

A. Kaffa and Hadiya B. Wolayta and Kaffa C. Khomosha and Nuer D. Shewa and Gamo

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: Both the Wolayta and Kaffa kingdoms were characterized by centralized kingship (the *Ka'o* in Kaffa and the *Kawo* in Wolayta) with elaborate court rituals.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These pairings represent societies with fundamentally different political structures (e.g., decentralized versus centralized).

97. With which of the following medieval African states was Timbuktu associated?

A. Mali B. Ghana C. Kanem Bornu D. Songhai

CORRECT ANSWER: A

Explanation: Timbuktu reached its height as a global center of scholarship and trade during the Mali Empire under rulers like Mansa Musa.

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WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **B, C, D:** While Timbuktu continued to be important in Songhai, it was "associated" and built as a scholarly capital during the Mali era.

98. Why was the second phase of the Trans-Atlantic slave trade also known as the Triangular trade?

A. Merchants involved in this trade transported slaves to the Americas using triangular shaped ships.

B. Transportation of slaves to the Americas passed through three distinctive phases.

C. Trade linked traders and goods drawn from the continents of Africa, Europe and the Americas.

D. Slave trade during this period was dominated by the Portuguese, Spanish and Dutch.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: The trade was a circuit: Europe (manufactured goods) -> Africa (slaves) -> Americas (raw materials) -> Europe, forming a physical triangle across the Atlantic.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These are incorrect explanations for the term "Triangular."

99. Which one of the following was a consequence of the Industrial Revolution?

A. The domination of European society by aristocrats devoted to farming and the manufacturing bourgeoisie.

B. The widening of income inequality between workers and capitalists.

C. The improvement of living and working conditions for factory workers.

D. Increase in unemployment due to the replacement of workers by machines.

CORRECT ANSWER: B

Explanation: The concentration of capital in the hands of factory owners (bourgeoisie) while the proletariat earned low wages resulted in a historic gap in income and quality of life.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, C, D:** These ignore the reality of class conflict and the initial degradation of labor standards during the revolution.

X-Less Africa Initiative

100. What was the fundamental cause of the American War of Independence?

A. The introduction of the different Acts by the British government.

B. The support France gave to the Colonists against the British.

C. The thirteen colonies rejection of strict rule by the British.

D. The passage of the Declaration of Independence by the colonists.

CORRECT ANSWER: C

Explanation: While the various Acts (Stamp Act, Tea Act) were the triggers, the *fundamental* cause was the colonies' belief in "no taxation without representation" and their demand for self-governance.

WHY THE OTHER OPTIONS ARE WRONG

- **A, B, D:** These were events and reactions, but the underlying rejection of British sovereignty was the fundamental cause.

X-Less Africa Initiative

T H E E N D